

THE NEW MOM CO



The Baby Sleep & Rhythm Blueprint (0-6 Months)



Your stress-free guide to peaceful
nights, predictable days & a well-
rested baby.

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Introduction



Why Baby Sleep Feels So Hard (And Why It's Not Your Fault)

If you're holding this guide, chances are you're tired. Not just “missed a couple of hours” tired — the kind of tired that seeps into your bones, makes you forget what day it is, and turns even making a cup of coffee into a mini-Olympic event.

Here's the truth: this is normal.

In the first months of life, your baby's brain and body are developing at lightning speed. Their sleep isn't “broken” — it's simply not the same as adult sleep yet.

The real challenge? Most advice out there pushes unrealistic schedules, rigid sleep training, or conflicting methods that leave parents more stressed than supported.



The Blueprint Philosophy: Gentle, Responsive, Science-Backed

This isn't a sleep training manual.

Instead, it's a **rhythm-based approach** — using gentle patterns, biological sleep cues, and proven environmental tweaks to help your baby (and you) rest better without resorting to “cry it out.”

Our focus: **rest over rules, connection over control.**

How to Use This Guide Without Overwhelm

Think of this book like a sleep buffet — you don't need to use every single strategy at once.

Instead:

- Skim the **Quick Tools** for instant relief on rough nights.
- Use the **Sample Rhythms** to set up your day.
- Refer to the **Troubleshooting Guides** when sleep suddenly falls apart (because it will — and that's normal).

You'll leave with not just tips, but a **flexible, realistic blueprint** you can adjust as your baby grows.



Chapter 1: The Science of Newborn Sleep

If you've ever wondered why your newborn seems to wake the moment you put them down—or why some days they nap for hours and others barely at all—you're not alone.

Understanding the biology of newborn sleep is like being handed the map to a new country.

This chapter will help you decode how your baby's sleep system actually works, so you can work with it instead of feeling like you're always fighting against it.

01 Baby Sleep Cycles: Short & Active

- **Adults** have sleep cycles of about 90 minutes, moving through light and deep sleep phases.
- **Newborns?** Their cycles last only **40–50 minutes**.
- Half of that time is spent in **REM (active sleep)**—light, twitchy, noisy sleep where brain growth happens.
- The other half is **Non-REM (quiet sleep)**—deep, still, and restorative.



Why it matters: Frequent waking isn't "bad sleeping"; it's biologically normal and supports brain development.

02 Circadian Rhythms: The Internal Clock Isn't Set Yet

- Babies aren't born knowing day from night.
- The **circadian rhythm** (body's internal clock) starts developing around **6–8 weeks** and matures around **3–4 months**.
- This clock is influenced by **light exposure**, feeding times, and social interaction.



Your Role: Use **natural daylight** exposure in the morning. Keep **nighttime interactions calm, dim, and quiet** to signal "night" to your baby's brain.

03 Sleep Pressure: Why Wake Windows Matter

- **Sleep pressure** is the build-up of adenosine in the brain that makes us feel sleepy.
- For newborns, it builds quickly—meaning short wake windows are crucial.
- **Typical wake windows:**
 - 0–6 weeks: 45–60 minutes
 - 6–12 weeks: 60–90 minutes
 - 3–6 months: 75–120 minutes



Why it matters: Missing the window can lead to overtiredness, making it harder for baby to fall and stay asleep.

04 The Role of Feeding in Sleep

- Newborn stomachs are **tiny**—about the size of a marble at birth, growing to an egg by 1 month.
- Frequent feeding supports growth and helps baby settle.
- Night feeds are normal and biologically expected for at least the first 3–4 months.

- Newborn sleep totals: **14–17 hours in 24h** (not all at once!)
- Active sleep supports **brain wiring**; quiet sleep supports **physical growth**.
- Sleep is regulated by **both sleep pressure and circadian rhythm**—one develops instantly, the other over months.

QUICK FACTS:



Chapter 2: The Rhythm Over Schedule Approach

The internet is full of baby “schedules” that promise perfect naps and blissful nights—usually with color-coded charts and rigid time slots. But here’s the truth: in the first six months, babies are not ready for clock-based schedules. What works better?

A **rhythm**—a gentle, predictable flow that adapts to your baby’s cues and developmental stage.

This chapter will show you how to create that rhythm so you both feel more grounded and less stressed.

- Babies thrive on predictability, but that doesn’t mean rigid schedules.
- Rhythms reduce parent stress and make it easier to spot developmental changes.
- Consistent anchors can help regulate circadian rhythm faster.

Why Strict Schedules Fail in the Newborn Stage

- Babies’ sleep and feed needs change **week to week**, sometimes day to day.
- Growth spurts, cluster feeding, developmental leaps, and illness can throw off fixed times.
- Following the clock instead of your baby can lead to underfeeding, overtiredness, and unnecessary stress.

★ **Takeaway:** Flexibility now leads to better sleep later

The Science Behind a Rhythm

A **rhythm** is based on patterns, not the exact time on the clock.

- Watch for **wake windows** rather than fixed nap times.
- Notice **feeding patterns**—some babies feed every 2 hours, others every 3.
- Anchor the day with a **few predictable points** (like first morning feed and bedtime routine).

Building Your Baby’s Daily Flow

Think of the day as a repeating loop: **Eat** → **Awake** → **Sleep**

Eat:

Full feed, not snacking, when possible.

Awake:

Play, tummy time, gentle interaction.

Sleep:

Naps, with wake windows adjusted for age.

Anchors vs. Fixed Times

Anchors are predictable events in the day that help orient baby’s internal clock without strict scheduling:

- **Morning wake-up**
- **Bedtime routine**
- Optional: a **midday walk, bath, or storytime**

★ **Pro tip:** Start the day within a consistent range (e.g., between 6:30–7:30 am) instead of a fixed minute.

Real-Life Rhythm Examples

Newborn (0–8 weeks)

- Feed every 2–3 hours, nap after 45–60 min awake.
- Bedtime “start” can be later—around 9–10 pm.

2–4 months

- Feed every 3 hours, wake windows lengthen to 75–90 min.
- Bedtime shifts earlier—around 7–8 pm.

APPENDIX

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Chapter 3: The Sleep Environment Blueprint

The Science of the Sleep Environment

- Newborns' circadian rhythms are immature, so they rely heavily on **environmental cues** to distinguish day from night.
- Temperature, noise, and light directly impact sleep quality and safety.
- A consistent environment helps regulate baby's **sleep-wake hormones** (melatonin and cortisol).

Safe Sleep Guidelines (Non-Negotiables)

- 01 Baby sleeps on their back**
for every sleep, until age 1
- 02 Firm, flat sleep surface**
(crib, bassinet, portable play yard).
- 03 No soft bedding, pillows, or toys**
in the sleep space.
- 04 Share a room**
(not a bed) for at least the first 6 months.



Pro Tip:

Safety first, then comfort.
Never compromise on these basics.

Setting Up Your Sleep Zone

- **Crib/Bassinet Placement:** Away from windows, heaters, and cords.
- **Lighting:** Soft, warm nightlight for night feeds and diaper changes.
- **White Noise Machine:** Constant, at a safe distance (at least 7 feet from crib).
- **Clutter-Free Zone:** Safe, breathable sleep space only.

QUICK FACTS:

- Darkness triggers melatonin release, aiding sleep onset.
- White noise can lengthen sleep cycles by preventing wake-ups from small noises.
- Room-sharing without bed-sharing lowers SIDS risk by up to 50%.



Light Control

Day naps: Dim but not pitch black—so baby learns day vs. night.

Night sleep: Total darkness (blackout curtains or portable blackout shades).



Temperature & Airflow

Ideal room temp: **68–72°F (20–22°C)**.

Use a breathable sleep sack instead of blankets.



Sound

Continuous **white noise** helps mimic the womb and blocks disruptive sounds. Avoid intermittent sounds (e.g., ocean waves) that can startle baby.



Scent & Comfort

Keep space neutral; strong scents can be overstimulating. A parent's natural scent on a sleep sack can be comforting.

Sleep Friendly Space - Key Elements

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Chapter 4: Navigating Growth spurts

The Science Behind Sleep Disruption

- **Growth spurts:** Short periods (2–3 days) when babies feed more to support physical growth.
- **Developmental leaps:** Cognitive milestones that temporarily disrupt sleep as the brain processes new skills (e.g., smiling, rolling, babbling).
- Hormonal changes (like increased growth hormone) can make babies more restless at night.

How to Handle Growth Spurts

DO

Offer extra feeds (breast or bottle).
Keep sleep environment consistent.
Soothe with motion (rocking, stroller walks).

DON'T

Expect “perfect” schedules during spurts.
Drop night feeds prematurel.

How to Handle Developmental Leaps

AWAKE TIME

Give baby extra practice with new skills.
Provide stimulating but not overwhelming activities.

SLEEP TIME

Keep pre-sleep routine the same.
Offer comfort but avoid introducing long-term sleep crutches you don't want to keep.

When to Expect Them (0–6 Months)

Age	What's Happening	Common Sleep Effects
2–3 weeks	First big growth spurt	More night feeds, shorter naps
6 weeks	Rapid weight gain	Cluster feeding, fussy evenings
8–9 weeks	First leap (awareness increase)	Fighting naps, distracted feeding
3 months	Rolling, visual focus improves	Night waking, shorter naps
4 months	Major leap + sleep cycle change	Frequent waking, harder bedtime
6 months	Sitting prep, solids intro	Early morning wakes, nap resistance

Your Survival Kit for Sleep Disruptions



White Noise
for consistency



Flexible mindset
(accept naps might be shorter)



Babywearing
for contact naps when needed



Extra snacks/water
for you during night feeds



Chapter 5: Overtiredness & Undertiredness

One of the trickiest parts of newborn sleep is figuring out when to put your baby down. Too soon, and they may happily babble in the crib for 40 minutes before melting down. Too late, and you get the dreaded overtired crying that feels impossible to soothe. This chapter will help you spot the signs, understand the science, and adjust your baby's wake windows in real time so sleep becomes smoother and less of a gamble.

The Science of Sleep Pressure

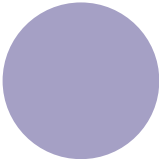
- Babies build “sleep pressure” the longer they’re awake, thanks to adenosine accumulation in the brain.
- The trick: hitting the sweet spot where enough sleep pressure has built up—but not so much that stress hormones (cortisol) surge.
- Overtiredness = too much cortisol, making it hard to fall asleep and stay asleep.
- Undertiredness = not enough adenosine, making baby restless or playful in the crib.

Signs of Overtiredness vs. Undertiredness

Overtired Baby	Undertired Baby
Red eyebrows/eyelids	Wide-eyed, playful
Rubbing eyes	Babbling in crib
Jerky arm/leg movements	Rolling or kicking
Fussing hard before sleep	“Happy” but won’t sleep
Short naps (<30 min)	Long time to fall asleep
Frequent night wakes	Early waking without fuss

Wake Windows for 0–6 Months (Guidelines, not rules)

Age	Typical Wake Window	Notes
0–4 weeks	40–60 min	Includes feeding time
1–2 months	60–75 min	Morning wake window shortest
3 months	75–90 min	May stretch longer in afternoon
4 months	90–120 min	Adjust for nap quality
5–6 months	2–2.5 hrs	Last wake window before bed can be longer



How to Adjust in Real Time

If Overtired

- 01** Shorten the next wake window by 10–15 min.
- 02** Add calming activities (dim lights, slow rocking).
- 03** Use contact nap or carrier to help reset the cycle.

If Undertired

- 01** Add 10–15 min of awake time before next nap.
- 02** Offer gentle stimulation (tummy time, singing).
- 03** Avoid overstimulation right before nap.

The “10-Minute Test” Method

If baby is fussing before sleep, pause and observe for 10 minutes:

- If fuss escalates → likely overtired, soothe and attempt again.
- If fuss stays light/playful → likely undertired, extend wake time briefly.

QUICK FACTS:

- Cortisol can stay elevated for hours after overtiredness, affecting multiple naps.
- Morning naps often need the shortest wake windows of the day.
- Undertiredness is a common cause of “false starts” (waking 30–45 min after bedtime).

APPENDIX

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Chapter 6: Contact Naps & The Bassinet Transition

If your newborn seems to sleep only on you or only in a moving stroller or car seat, you're not alone. Contact naps and motion naps are part of a baby's natural survival instinct: closeness means safety. This chapter will show you why these naps happen, how to make the most of them, and how to gently encourage independent sleep when the time feels right.

Why Contact Naps Happen

Biological Reason

In the fourth trimester, babies regulate their breathing, temperature, and heart rate better when held.

Attachment

Proximity fosters secure bonding and emotional development.

Ease of Soothing

Being on a caregiver's chest makes it easier for babies to drift back into the next sleep cycle.

Why Motion Naps Happen

- **Vestibular soothing:** Rocking or gentle motion mimics the womb experience.
- **Quick calming effect:** Especially helpful during growth spurts or overtired phases.
- **On-the-go convenience:** Allows parents to get outside or run errands without disrupting nap times.

Using Contact & Motion Naps Wisely

When they're helpful:

- During illness or developmental leaps.
- To extend a short nap when baby is overtired.
- When traveling or visiting family.

Possible downsides

if they're the only nap method:

- Baby may resist bassinet or crib sleep.
- Can limit caregiver's mobility over time.

Gentle Transition to Bassinet Naps

01 Start with one nap a day in the bassinet

Choose baby's easiest nap of the day (often morning nap).

02 Mimic the contact nap environment

Warm the bassinet sheet with your hand before laying baby down. Use your scent (sleeping on a muslin cloth, then placing it near- not under - the baby's head).

03 Add soothing cues

White noise, swaddle/sleep sack, and dim lighting.

04 The "Pick-Up/Put-Down" Technique

Lay baby down drowsy but awake. If fussing escalates, pick up, soothe, and try again. Repeat until baby settles or until nap time is over.

QUICK FACTS

- In the first 12 weeks, most babies need help transitioning between sleep cycles.
- Gradual exposure to the bassinet helps prevent nap resistance later.
- Some babies naturally accept independent sleep around 5–6 months with minimal intervention.

APPENDIX

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Chapter 7: **Bedtime** **Routines That** **Actually Work**

A predictable bedtime routine is like a lullaby for your baby's body clock. It tells their brain, "It's time to rest." The goal isn't perfection, but consistency — a simple, repeatable sequence that signals sleep time. In this chapter, we'll create an evening wind-down that works even on the busiest days.

The Science Behind Bedtime Routines

- Cortisol vs. Melatonin: Gentle, predictable cues lower cortisol (the stress hormone) and encourage melatonin production.
- Repetition builds sleep association: Babies learn through patterns, not rules.
- Attachment & emotional safety: A loving close to the day reassures your baby, making sleep easier.

The Step-by-Step Evening Wind-Down

Timing: Start 30–45 minutes before the target bedtime.

1 Bath or Warm Wash

- Not always daily (can be replaced with a warm washcloth wipe-down)
- Warm water helps relax muscles

2

Soft Pajamas & Sleep Sack

- Consistent "sleep clothes" act as a cue.

3

Last Feed

- Ideally in a dimly lit space to reduce stimulation.

4

Cuddle or Quiet Play

- Soft singing, gentle rocking, or reading a short board book.

5

White Noise & Lights Out

- Turn on white noise before laying baby down.
- Keep lighting low to signal night.

Flexible Routines for Real Life



Shorten routine if baby is overtired.



Skip bath if baby is fussy — go straight to pajamas, feed, cuddle.



Maintain core steps (feed → cuddle → lights out) even on travel days.

QUICK FACTS:

Routine length can vary but should feel calming and predictable.

APPENDIX

Babies who have a consistent bedtime routine tend to fall asleep faster and wake less during the night (Mindell et al., Sleep, 2009).



Chapter 8: Daytime Naps Without Stress

Daytime naps are the secret weapon for better nights. A well-rested baby falls asleep more easily and sleeps more soundly. This chapter will help you create a nap routine that works for your lifestyle – without turning your days into a rigid schedule.

The Ideal Nap Environment



Darkened room:
Use blackout curtains to mimic nighttime.



White noise:
Masks household sounds.



Comfortable temperature:
68–72°F (20–22°C).

Wake Windows & Nap Timing

0–6 Weeks

45–60
Minutes Awake

6–12 Weeks

60–75
Minutes Awake

3–4 Months

75–120
Minutes Awake

5–6 Months

2–2.30
Hours Awake

Linking Sleep Cycles

1

Soothing at the transition:

Enter room before expected wake time, gently pat or rock without picking up.

2

Contact nap extension:

Transfer to your arms when they stir, then hold for the second half of the nap.

3

White noise consistency:

Keep it running through the nap to reduce arousals.

QUICK FACTS:

Naps prevent overtiredness, which often leads to night waking.

APPENDIX

Daytime sleep supports brain development and emotional regulation (Thorpe et al., Sleep Medicine Reviews).



Chapter 9: Night Wakings & Feeding Rhythms

Night wakings in the first six months are normal – but not all wakings are about hunger. This chapter helps you tell the difference, respond effectively, and set the stage for smoother nights when your baby is ready.

Hunger vs. Comfort Waking

Signs of Hunger Waking:

- Rooting or sucking motions
- Hands to mouth
- Escalating cry that doesn't stop with patting

Signs of Comfort Waking:

- Light fussing
- Settles quickly with a pacifier or gentle pat
- Short cry that fades without full feed

Supporting Night Feeds Without Fully Waking Baby

- Keep lights off or dim red light.
- Avoid talking or stimulating play.
- Use a consistent, calm routine for feeding.

Night Weaning Readiness (Usually after 4–6 months)

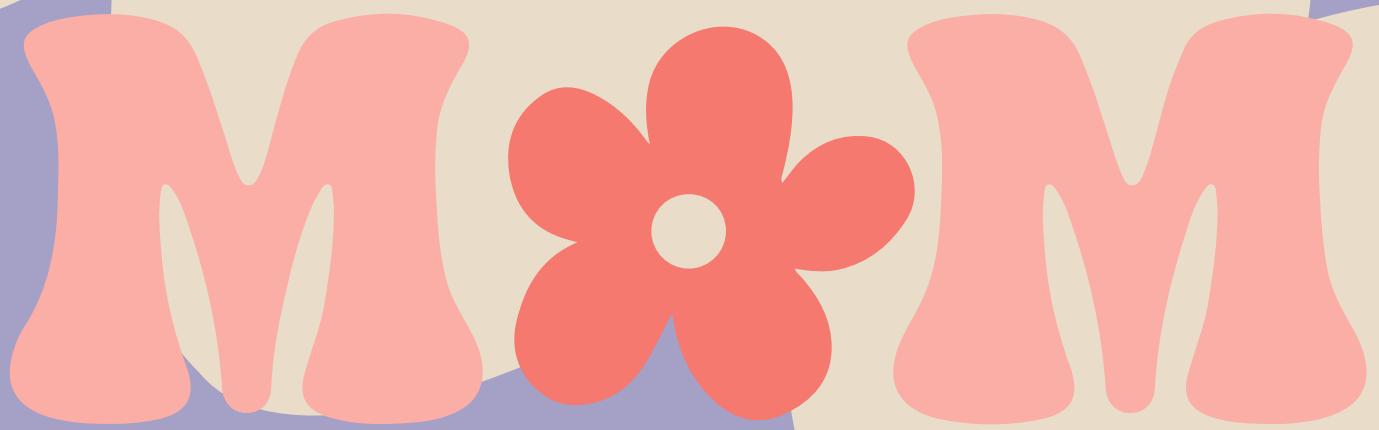
- ✓ Pediatrician approval based on weight gain & feeding patterns.
- ✓ Baby taking more feeds during the day and fewer at night naturally.
- ✓ Comforted easily without feeding for at least one waking.

QUICK FACTS

- Average newborn wakes 2–3 times a night in the first 3 months.
- Sleep training is not recommended before 4–6 months and should always be gentle.

APPENDIX

Responsive nighttime care fosters secure attachment (Middlemiss et al., Early Human Development).



Chapter 10: Maximizing Your Own Rest

When you're caring for a newborn, your sleep often feels like an afterthought — but it's not optional. Rest fuels your ability to parent, recover, and think clearly. This chapter offers practical, guilt-free strategies to help you reclaim moments of rest, even when nights are broken.

The Power of Strategic Napping

- 20–30 minute “reset naps” for energy without grogginess.
- Nap early afternoon if possible — too late can make bedtime harder.
- Use white noise, an eye mask, and phone on silent.
- If baby only contact-naps, rest alongside them on a safe surface.

Shifts with Your Partner



Split the night:

One parent handles bedtime to 2 a.m., the other 2 a.m. to morning.



Split the morning:

One gets up with baby at first waking, other sleeps in for an extra hour.



Use bottles of expressed milk or formula for the partner's shift if feeding is established.

QUICK FACTS

Even a single 20-minute nap can restore alertness and improve mood (NASA nap study).

Letting Go of the “Perfect” Plan



Rest looks different in this season

Accept shorter sleep blocks.

Say yes to help from friends/family, even if it's just one chore done for you.

family



Lower non-essential tasks (perfect laundry folds can wait).



Chapter 11: When to Seek Extra Help



Most sleep challenges in the first 6 months are developmental and temporary. But sometimes, expert guidance can make a huge difference — especially if sleep issues persist or are paired with feeding and growth concerns. This chapter helps you know when and how to seek extra support.

Professional Support Options

1

Sleep Consultants

Offer personalized sleep plans for your family's needs. Best used after 4–6 months when baby's sleep patterns are more predictable.

2

Pediatricians

First stop for ruling out medical causes of poor sleep. Can check for reflux, ear infections, growth issues, or sleep-related breathing problems.

3

Lactation Consultants (IBCLCs)

Address feeding difficulties that may impact sleep length and quality. Help troubleshoot low milk supply, latch issues, or frequent night feeding needs.

Red Flags for Medical Sleep Issues

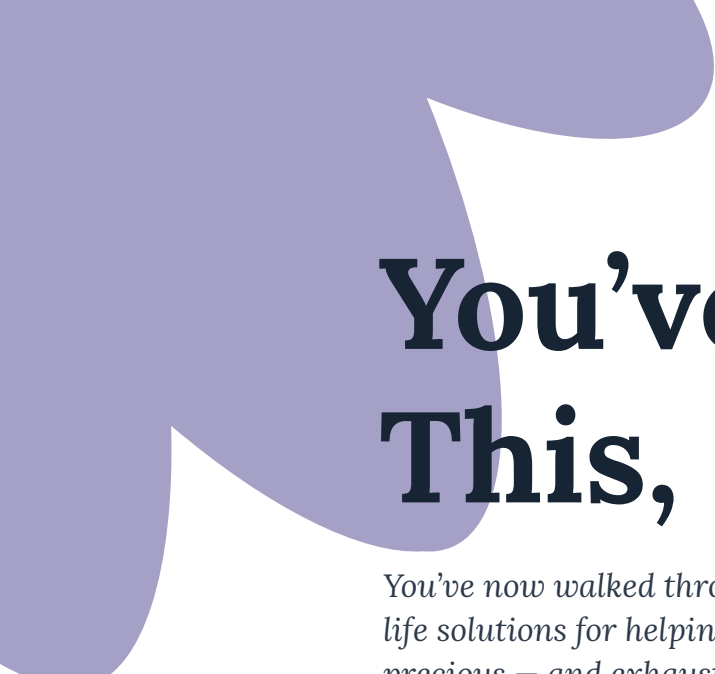
Loud snoring, pauses in breathing, or gasping sounds during sleep.

Consistent feeding refusal or poor weight gain.

Excessive irritability that doesn't improve with feeding and rest.

Persistent vomiting or signs of reflux interfering with sleep.





You've Got This, Mama

You've now walked through the science, the strategies, and the real-life solutions for helping your baby (and you) rest better during the precious — and exhausting — first 6 months.

Here's the truth: perfect sleep doesn't exist in the newborn stage. What does exist is progress. Each gentle rhythm you introduce, each safe and nurturing environment you create, is planting the seeds for healthy sleep habits that will carry your baby into toddlerhood and beyond.

You're not just managing nights — you're building connection, security, and trust. Every time you respond to a sleepy cry, every moment you pause to read your baby's cues, you're teaching them the most important lesson of all:

"I am safe. I am loved. My needs matter."

When the days blur and the nights feel long, remember this: sleep isn't a test you have to pass. It's a rhythm you and your baby will learn together, one small win at a time.

Keep this guide close, revisit it as your baby grows, and give yourself permission to adapt without guilt. Your intuition is your greatest sleep tool — trust it.

And when all else fails?

Take a deep breath. Snuggle your baby. And know that this season, as hard as it feels, is only one chapter in your beautiful story of motherhood.

You've got this — truly.

Your Quick-Start Action Plan

1. Choose one small change from this guide to try tonight.
2. Track your baby's rhythms for 3–5 days to see patterns clearly.
3. Celebrate every extra minute of rest you both get.



**BONUS
RESOURCES**

1. Baby Sleep Cues Quick Guide

Early Sleep Cues (Act Now)	Late Sleep Cues (Overtired)
Staring off into space	Rubbing eyes or ears
Slower body movements	Fussiness or whining
Less social engagement	Arching back
Red eyebrows / glazed look	Crying that escalates quickly

Tip: Respond to early cues whenever possible — it's the fastest way to easier settling.

2. Wake Windows by Age (0–6 Months)

Age	Wake Window	Average Naps/day	Approx. Bedtime
0–6 weeks	30–60 min	4–6+	8–10 pm
6–12 weeks	60–75 min	4–5	8–9 pm
3–4 months	75–120 min	3–4	7–8 pm
5–6 months	2–2.5 hrs	2–3	6:30–7:30 pm

3. Safe Sleep Checklist

#	Action
✓	Baby sleeps on their back — every nap, every night
✓	Firm, flat sleep surface (no pillows, bumpers, toys)
✓	Sleep sack or swaddle (until rolling starts) — no loose blankets
✓	Room temperature: 68–72°F (20–22°C)
✓	No smoking, alcohol, or drugs near baby
✓	Baby's sleep space in your room for the first 6 months

4. Sample Daily Rhythm (3–4 Months)

Time	Feed (Breast/Bottle)
7:00 AM	Wake, feed
8:15 AM	Nap 1
9:00 am	Wake, feed, play
10:45 am	Nap 2
12:00 pm	Wake, feed, tummy time
1:45 pm	Nap 3
3:00 pm	Wake, feed, play
4:30 pm	Nap 4 (short)
5:00 pm	Wake, feed
6:30 pm	Bath / wind-down routine
7:00 pm	Bedtime
10:30 pm	Optional dream feed

5. Night Waking Troubleshooting Flowchart

01 Is it within 2–3 hours of last feed? **Feed**

02 Is diaper wet/soiled? → **Change quickly, keep lights dim**

03 Too hot/too cold? → **Adjust layers or temperature**

04 Still upset after needs met? → **Rock, shush, or comfort**

05 Frequent wakings every 30–60 min? → **Check for overtiredness, reflux, or growth spurt**

6. Printable Sleep Log

Sample Tracker

Date	Wake Time	Nap #1 (start/end)	Nap #2 (start/end)	Nap #3 (start/end)	Bedtime	Night Wakings (times)	Notes (feeding, mood, milestones)
8/14	7:00 AM	8:20–9:05 AM	11:15–12:00 PM	2:10–2:50 PM	7:15 PM	11:30 PM, 3:00 AM	Tried white noise, first time rolling over
8/15	6:50 AM	8:10–8:55 AM	10:50–11:35 AM	1:55–2:40 PM	7:10 PM	1:15 AM, 4:10 AM	Cluster fed in evening, more fussy at night
8/16	7:05 AM	8:25–9:15 AM	11:10–12:05 PM	2:20–3:00 PM	7:20 PM	12:45 AM, 5:30 AM	Nap #3 was in stroller, better mood overall

How to Use This Log

1. Track for 5–7 days in a row to see patterns.
2. Watch for consistent sleep cues and wake windows.
3. Use the notes column to record feeding times, growth spurts, illness, or big events (which can affect sleep).
4. Share with your pediatrician or sleep consultant if needed.

Tip: If your baby’s wake-up and bedtime shift wildly each day, start by anchoring just one — usually morning wake-up — within a 30-minute window. The rest will start to fall into place.

7. Parent Sleep Survival Mini-Plan

1

Power naps:
20–40 minutes
when baby
sleeps

2

Split nights:
One partner
handles early
hours, one the
late hours

3

Rest space:
Keep a cozy
blanket and eye
mask in your
baby’s room for
short rests

4

No guilt:
Some days the
priority is
simply survival
— that’s okay